SEMINAR PRESENTATION

Concepts of Rasa in Relation to Prasuti Tantra & Stree Roga

Six rasa, their therapeutics, and the classical prohibition on rasa in pregnancy

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> *Rasa is the most potent and the most restricted category in Ayurveda. This seminar explains where the line is drawn in women's health.*

Abstract

Rasa occupies a distinctive position in Ayurvedic pharmacology as the most refined and most potent preparation class, formed through shodhana, marana and bhavana processes. This seminar explores the concept of Rasa in relation to Prasuti Tantra and Stree Roga, tracing the classical definitions of rasa, the pharmacological action attributed to rasaushadhi, the relationship between rasa and agni, and the classical cautions governing their use across the reproductive life-cycle — particularly in pregnancy, where specific rasa preparations are contraindicated. The discussion also addresses the modern pharmacological framework of drug action and how rasaushadhi effects may be correlated with known therapeutic and adverse-reaction profiles, providing a grounded basis for their cautious clinical application.

Rasa · Rasaushadhi · Prasuti Tantra · Stree Roga · Ayurveda · Pharmacology · Agnidega · Bhavapaka

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Topic of Presentation

CONCEPTS OF RASA IN RELATION TO PRASUTI TANTRA EVAM STREE ROGA

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INTRODUCTION OF RASA:-

निरुक्ति OF रस:-

रस आस्वादने| (वाचस्पत्यम्)

Rasa or taste is something experienced by an individual while consuming a Dravya.

रसनार्थो रस: तस्य द्रव्यमाप: क्षितिस्तथा ।

निर्वृत्तौ च विशेषे च प्रत्यया: खादयस्त्रय: ॥ (च.सु.1/64)

Taste perception is the characteristic feature of Rasa. It is basically provided by two bhutas- Jala and Prithvi.

And vishesh Knowledge of Rasa is provided by Vayu, Agni and Akash.

रसनेन्द्रिय ग्राह्यत्वात् रस: । (अ.हृ.सु 1/14)

Rasa is the special sense known through the Rasanendriya (Tongue or taste buds)

TYPES OF रस:-

According to Punarvasu Atreya there are mainly 6 Rasas,

RASA IN RELATION WITH PANCHMAHABHAUTIK:-

RASA

MAHABHOOT

Madhur

Pruthvi + Jala

Amla

Pruthvi + Agni

Lavana

Jala + Agni

Katu

Vayu + Agni

Tikta

Vayu + Aakash

Kashaya

Vayu + Pruthvi

RASA IN RELATION WITH DOSHA:-

DOSHA

KOPAK RASA

SHAAMAK RASA

VATA

Katu, Tikta, Kashaya

Madhur, Amla, Lavana

PITTA

Katu, Amla, Lavana

Tikta, Madhur, Kashaya

KAPHA

Madhur, Amla, Lavana

Katu, Tikta, Kashaya

RELATION OF RASA IN STREE ROGA:-

Doshaj Condition in Stree roga:-

योनि व्यापद:- There are total 20 vyapad.

- According to Acharya charak,

Vtaja – 11

Pittaja – 3

Kaphaja – 1

Tridoshaja – 1

Vatpittaja – 2

Vatkaphaj – 2

आर्तव व्यापत:- Total 8 menstrual disorder is there.

Vataja

Pittaja

Kaphaja

Raktaja

Vatapittaja

Pittakaphaja

Vatakaphaja

Tridoshaja

असृग्दर OR प्रदर:- 4

Vataja

Pittaja

Kaphaja

Sannipataj

So, in these all diseases according to dominance of Dosha we can use Doshshamak Rasa dravya in treatment.

FOR EXAMPLE,

In Vataja Roga – Madhura, Amla & Lavana Rasatmak dravya can be used.

e.g, In Vataja Yonivyapada Ghritpana of Kashmari, Triphala, Draksha, Kasamarda, Shatavari etc used. (Ch.chi.30)

In Vataja asrugdara Dadhi(Curd) mixed with Sharkara, Madhu & Nagar should be used. (ch.chi.30/87)

In these examples the dravya which are used having predominance of Madhura and amla rasa so they can supress increased vata dosha.

In Pittaja Roga – Tikta, Madhur & Kashaya Rasatmak dravya can be used.

e.g, In Pittaja Asrukdara Chandanadi or Rasnadi Niruha basti can be used. (ch.si.3)

- Kushadi Asthaapan basti in Pittaja Asrukdar. (Su.chi.38)

- Shatavari Ghrita and Kushmand Avleha also used in pittaja Asukdar and Yonivyapada.

In these examples the dravyas having predominance of Madhur, Tikta and Kashaya so they supress increased Pitta dosha.

In Kaphaja Roga – Katu, Tikta & Kashaya Rasatmak dravya can be used.

e.g, In Kaphaja Aartava dushti Kalka of madanphala should be applied in vaginal canal. (Yoni dharan)(A.San.Sha.1/32)

- In kaphaja Asrukdar – Paan of Nimba & Guduchi with Madhya(Wine)(ch.chi.30)

- In kaphaja Yonivyapada – Basti of Gomutra mixed with the drugs having predominantly Katu rasatmak should be given. (Ch.chi.30/85)

So here in these examples also the dravyas having predominance of Katu, Tikta and Kashaya so they can supress increased Kapha dosha.

Likewise in Pitta-kaphaj condition – Yoni Prakshaalan with Panchvalkal kwath can be used because they having predominantly Kashaya & Tikta Rasa.

In Pitta-vataj condition – Shatavari ghrita & Balaashwagandha taila can be used because of having Madhura rasa.

And In Kapha-vataja condition – Uttarbasti with the oil medicated with Jivaniya group of drugs should be given.

o According to Acharya charak,

श्लेश्म्लायां कटुप्राया: समूत्रा बस्तयो हिता: ।

पित्ते समधुरक्षीरा वाते तैलाम्लसंयुता: ॥ (ch.chi.30/85)

In kaphaj yoniroga uttar basti should be given with gomutra mixed with katu rasatmak dravya

In Pittaja Yoniroga uttar basti with kwath or kshir mixed with Madhur rasatmak dravya

And in Vataj Yoniroga uttar basti should be given with taila and amla rasa yukta kwath or swaras.

AYURVEDIC PHARMACOLOGICAL ACTIONS OF RASA:-

In Kaphaja Vyadhi:-

Katu(Pungent) Rasa reduces the increased Pichhila (Stickyness) quality and Guru of kapha dosha with the help of opposite Ruksha quality and Laghu quality of Katu Rasa by the action of absorption process.

Tikta(Bitter) Rasa decreases sweet taste from mouth & makes the mouth bitter and due Vishaad i.e. clean/clear quality it liquify the Pichchila guna of Kapha dosha by the breakdown process.

Kashaya(Astingent) Rasa due to its Ruksha & sheet quality it absorbs the snigdhansh(oiliness) of kapha dosha and stops its secretion respectively.

In Pittaja Vyadhi:-

Tikta Rasa decreases Saam pitta condition i.e., undigested food along with Pitta due to Vishaad(clean/clear) quality it liquefies the stickiness of Aam by the breakdown Process.

Madhur(sweet) Rasa decreases hot quality of pitta dosha by the qualities like shita and guru by the action of suppression.

Kashaya Rasa due to its Ruksha & shita quality it absorbs the Dravata(liquid condition) & prevents the secretion of pitta dosha respectively.

In Vataja Vyadhi:-

Lavana(Salty) Rasa produces moistness in the pathway of vaat dosha so vaat dosha easily moves and due to ushna quality it reduces the increased coldness of vaat & due to heaviness(guru) quality reduces the Laghuta(lightness) of Vaat dosha by stimulating Process.

Amla (Sour) Rasa stimulates the channel i.e., pathway of vaat dosha for its movement in its regular & normal direction by the help of qualities like Ushna, Tikshna & Snigdha.

Madhur rasa with the help of its qualities like Guru, Pichchila and snigdha reduces the main increased qualities of vaat dosha i.e., Laghu, Vishaad & Ruksha by its Opposite Characteristics.

KARMA OF RASAS AND THEIR RELATION TO PSR:-

Madhur Rasa:-

Vata-Pitta shamak, Kapha Vardhak

According to Ashtang Hrudaya,

आजन्मसात्म्यात्कुरुते धातुनाम् प्रबलम् बलम् ।

बालवृध्द क्षतक्षीणवर्णकिशेन्द्रियौजसाम्॥

प्रशस्तो ब्रुहणम् कण्ठ्य: स्तन्यसन्धान्कृद्गुरु:।

आयुष्यो जीवन: स्निग्ध: पित्तानिलविषापह: ॥(A.Hr.Su.10/7-8)

Madhura rasa being accustomed since birth

Produces greater strength in the dhatus

Good for children, the aged, the wounded, the emaciated and also good for complexion, hairs, sense organs and Ojas

Causes nourishment, good for throat, Increases breast milk, unites broken things

Prolongs life, Unctous and mitigates Pitta, vata and Visha

According to Acharya Charak,(Ch.Su.26/43)

शुक्राभिवर्धन- Increasing Shukra dhatu

According to Acharya Sushruta,(Su.su.42/10)

शुक्रस्तन्यवर्धन- Increases Breast milk and shukra

So, in Prasuti tantra Madhur rasa is best for garbhini.

In Garbhini Paricharya Madhur rasa is advised because it gives Strength & increase Oja guna which is best for development of fetus.

E.g., ह्रधं द्रवमं मधुरप्रायं स्निग्धं दिपनीयसन्स्कृतं च भोजनं भोजयेत् ।

(su.sha.10/3)

- Garbhini should use palatable, liquid, sweet and unctuous substances treated with Dipaniya things.

This rasa is also helpful for formation of stanya(breast milk). So, all stanyajanan drugs which are described by our acharya is Madhur rasa dominance.

e.g., Stanya janan dravya – Ushir, Shali, Kush, Ikshu, Viran, Ikshuvalika, Darbh etc.

- Garbhasthaapak Dravya- Aindri, Brahmi, Shatvirya(Durva), Sastravirya, Shiva, Mahabala, Priyangu

- Shukrajanan dravya- Jivak, Rishbhak, Kakoli, Kshirkakoli, Mudgaparni, Maashaparni, Meda, Shatavari, Jtamansi, Kuling

These all are having predominance of Madhur rasa.

Atiyoga of Madhur rasa:-

कुरुते अत्युपयोगेन स मेद: श्लेश्मजान् गदान्।

स्थौल्याग्निसादस्न्यासमेहगण्डार्बुदादिकान् ॥ (A.Hr.su.10/9)

By excess usage of this rasa produces diseases arising from meda and Kapha, Obesity, Loss of appetite, Unconsciousness, diabetes, enlargement of glands of the neck, Arbuda etc.

मधुरनित्या प्रमेहिणं मूकमतिस्थूलं वा । (cha.sha.8/21)

If garbhini takes daily use of sweet articles in excess then baby suffers from diabetes, obese & dumb.

Amla Rasa:-

Pitta-Kapha Vardhak, Vatanuloman

According to Ashtang Hrudaya,

अम्लो अग्निदीप्तिक्रुत्स्निग्धो ह्रद्य: पाचनरोचन: ।

उष्णवीर्यो हिमस्पर्श: प्रीणन: क्लेदनो लघु: ॥

करोति कफपित्तास्त्रम् मूढवातानुलोमन: । (A.Hr.su.10/10)

Amla stimulates the agni, unctuous, Good for heart, digestive, appetiser, hot in potency,cold on touch, causes moistening

Causes aggravation of kapha, pitta and asra(blood) and makes the inactive vata move downwords.

Amla rasa dravya causes aggravation of blood so it can be used in Artava kshaya.

e.g., In artavakshaya and nashtartav- Matsya(Fish), Kulattha, Kanji(Sour substances), tila, masha, sura, gomutra, dadhi etc. should be used in diet.

Atiyoga of Amla rasa:-

स अत्यभ्यस्तस्तनो: कुर्यात् शैथिल्यम् तिमिरम् भ्रमम् ।

कण्डूपाण्डुत्ववीसर्पशोफविस्फोटत्रुड्ज्वरान् ॥ (A.hr.su.10/11)

Used in excess causes loosness of the body, loss of strength, blindness, giddiness, itching, pallor

Also causes Visarpa, Swelling, Visphota, thirst and fever.

अम्लनित्या रक्तपित्तिनं त्वगक्षिरोगिणं वा । (cha.sha.8)

Daily using of sour taste by garbhini then baby suffers from bleeding disorders, skin and eye disorder.

Lavana rasa:-

Vata shaamak, Pitta-kapha vardhak

According to Ashtang hrudaya,

लवण: स्तम्भसन्घातबन्धविध्मापन् अग्निक्रुत ।

स्नेहन: स्वेदनस्तीक्ष्णो रोचन छेदभेदक्रुत् ॥ (A.hr.su.10/12)

Lavana rasa removes the rigidity, clears the obstruction, increase digestive activity, lubrication

Causes sweating, penetrates (into the tissue), improves taste, causes lacerations and bursting (of tissues, new growth, Abscess etc.)

In stree roga, because of having property of Chhedan and Bhedan lavana rasa can be used in Granthi.

For example in granthi(Uterine fibroid) Kshaar taila Uttar basti can be used.

Atiyoga of Lavana rasa:-

स अतियुक्त अस्त्रपवनम् खलति पलितम् वलिम् ।

त्रुट् कुष्ठविषवीसर्पान् जनयेत्क्षपयेद्बलम् ॥ (A.hr.su.10/13)

Used in excess, it causes increase of asra(blood) and pavana(vata), causes baldness, greying of hairs, wrinkles of the skin

Causes Thirst, skin diseases, effect of poison, visarpa and loss of strength.

According to Acharya charak,(Ch.su.26)

पुन्स्त्वम् उपहन्ति – Impotency

लवणनित्या शीघ्रवलीपलितं खालित्यरोगिणं वा । (ch.sha.8)

Daily using of salty dravya by garbhini then baby suffers from early wrinkling, greying of hairs and baldness.

Katu rasa:-

Kapha shaamak, vaat-pitta vardhak

According to Ashtang hrudaya,

कटुर्गलामयोदर्दकुष्ठालसकशोफजित् ।

व्रणावसादन: स्नेहमेद: क्लेदोपशोषण: ॥

दीपन: पाचनो रुच्य: शोधन् अन्नस्य शोषण: ।

छिनत्ति बन्धान् सत्रोतान्सि विव्रुणोति कफापह: ॥ (A.hr.su.10/18)

Katu cures the diseases of the throat, skin diseases, alasaka, swelling

Reduces the swelling of ulcers, dries up the unctuousness, fat and moisture

Increases hunger, digestive, improves taste, shodhan, break up hard masses, dilates the channels and mitigates the kapha.

According to Acharya Sushruta,(su.su.42/10)

स्तन्यशुक्रमेदसामुपहन्ता – Depletion of breast milk, shukra and meda.

Atiyoga of katu rasa:-

कुरुते स अतियोगेन त्रुष्णाम् शुक्रबलक्षयम् ।

मूर्च्छामाकुन्चनम् कम्पम् कटिप्रुष्ठादिषु व्यथाम् ॥ (A.hr.su.10/19)

By over use it causes thirst, depletion of shukra and strength, fainting, contractures, tremors and pain in the waist, back etc.

According to Acharya charak,(ch.su.26)

पुन्स्त्वम् उपहन्ति – Impotency

Atiyoga of this rasa leads to shukrakshaya because of its ushna guna.

कटुकनित्या दुर्बलमल्पशुक्रमनपत्यं वा । (ch.sha.8)

Daily use of pungent dravya by Garbhini then baby becomes weak, possess less quantity of shukra and infertile.

Ati katu tikta bhojana is the nidaan of garbhastraav or garbhapaat.

Tikta rasa:-

Pitta-kapha shaamak, vata vardhak

तिक्त: स्वयमरोचिष्णुररुचिम् क्रुमित्रुडविषम् ॥

कुष्ठमूर्छाज्वरोत्क्लेशदाहपित्तकफान् जयेत् ।

क्लेदमेदोवसामज्जशक्रुन्मूत्रोपशोषण: ॥

लघुर्मेध्यो हिमो रुक्ष: स्तन्यकण्ठविशोधन: । (A.hr.su.10/15)

Tikta rasa by itself it is not liked,it cures anorexia, worms, thirst, poison, skin diseases, loss of consciousness, fever, nausea, burning sensation

It dries up moisture, fat, faeces and urine, it is laghu, increases intillegence, cold in potency, dry

It cleanses the breast milk and throat.

Tikta rasa dravya is best for stanyashodhan (Purification of breast milk).

Stanya shodhana dravya - Ptha, shunthi, surdaru, musta, guduchi, vatsak, kiraattikt, katuk rohini, sariva etc.

Shukra shodhana dravya –kushtha, elvaluk, katphala, samudraphen, kadamb niryasa, kandekshu, kokilaksha, vasuk, ushir

Atiyoga of Tikta rasa:-

धातुक्षयानिलव्याधीनतियोगात्करोति स: ॥ (A.hr.su.10/16)

Used in excess causes depletion of Dhatus and diseases of vata origin.

तिक्तनित्या शोषिणमबलमनुपचितं वा । (ch.sha.8)

Daily use of bitter dravya by garbhini then baby suffers from emaciation and becomes weak.

Kashaya Rasa:-

Pitta-kapha hara, vata vardhak

कषाय: पित्तकफहा गुरुरस्त्रविशोधन: ।

पीडनो रोपण: शीत: क्लेदमेदोविशोषण: ॥

आमस्तम्भनो ग्राही रुक्षोति तक्प्रसादन: । (A.hr.su.10/20)

It is guru and cleanses the blood.

Causes healing and squeezing of ulcers, cold in potency, dries up the moisture and fat

It is water absorbent, dry and cleanses the skin too much.

Kashaya rasa having property of shoshan so in shwet pradar Yoni prakshaalan with Panchvalkal kashay can be used because of having Kashaya rasa.

Atiyoga of Kashaya Rasa:-

करोति शीलित: स अति विष्टम्भाध्मानहृद्रुज: ॥

त्रुट् कार्श्यपौरुषभ्रन्शस्त्रोतोरोधमलग्रहान् । (A.hr.su.10/21)

Used in excess, It causes statis of food without digestion, flatulence, pain in the heart, thirst, emaciation, loss of virility, obstruction of the channels and constipation.

कषायनित्या श्यावमानाहिनमुदावर्तिनं वा । (ch.sha.8)

If garbhini takes daily use of astringent dravya then baby becomes shyaav in complexion, flatulence and udavarta.

CONCLUSION:-

All above description of using rasa in order as medicine and food is based upon the basic concept of Samanyavishesh sidhdhant of Ayurved i.e., use of similar and opposite quality of drugs or food material to maintain the qualities present in the body elements (Dosha and Dhatu) at normal level. Due to this concept we can maintain our body and mind at healthy condition and cures the diseases effectively.

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